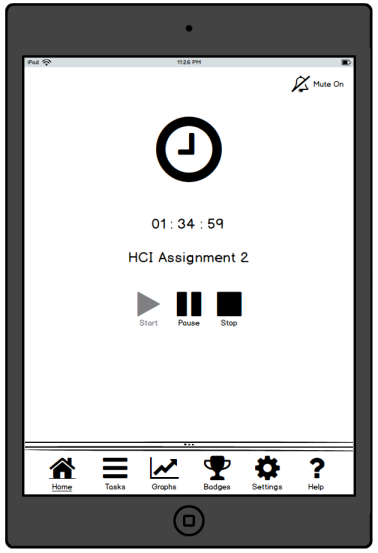
Design 1 - Timer Based

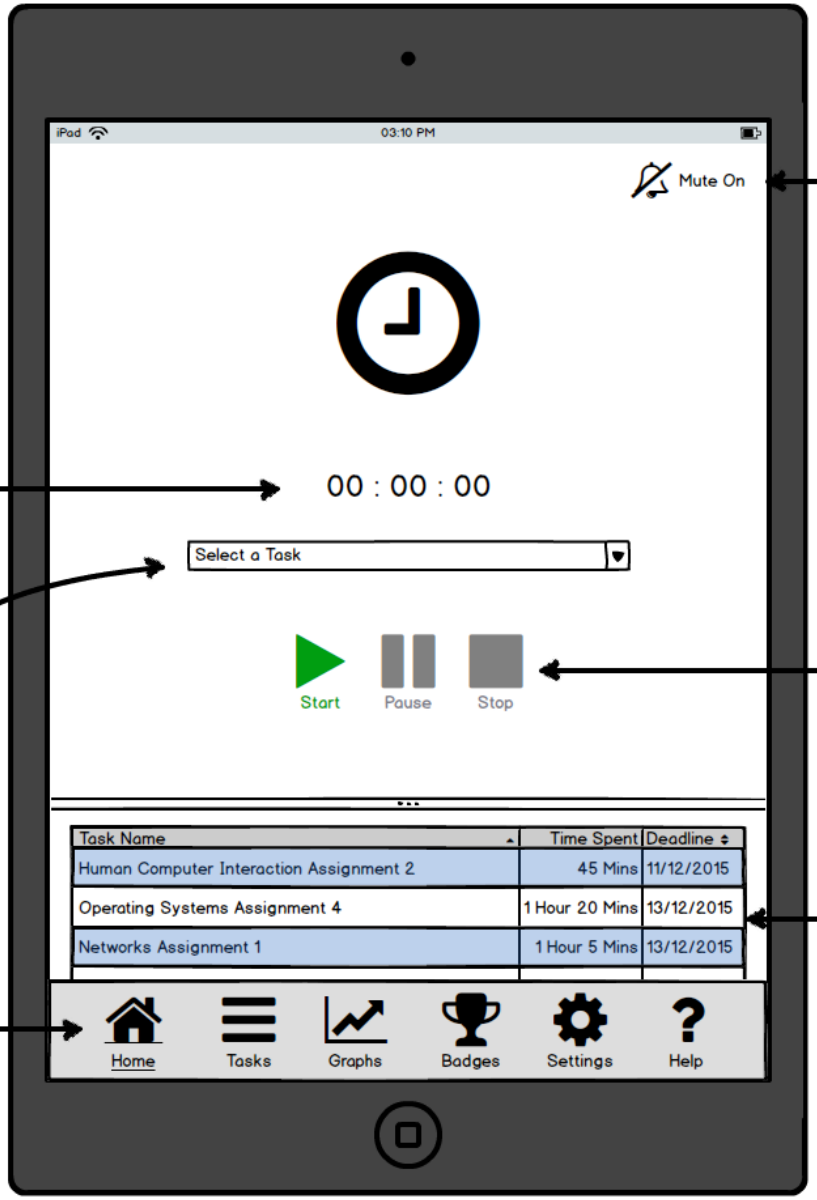
This design shows a way in which the user can make use of a timer to track their work on a particular task. They can view their tasks (ordered by deadline) and select one and start the timer. The design also lets the user pause and stop time for when they need a break whether short or long.



Sample view of application after the user has started the timer.

User can view the current elapsed time spent on the selected task.

User can select a task to work on.



Notifications mute button.

When the user has started the timer for a particular task then the device can be configured to be placed on mute.

During observation, we saw that one problem facing students working is the disruptions from messages. Putting the device on mute after the user has indicated they are working (started the timer) helps eliminate this distraction.

Easier start, pause and stop the timer.

During observation, we saw that it was apparent that students tended to perform a number of different tasks in a session. Whether this be researching information on the Internet or getting food etc. The use of a pause button is essential for helping tackle a constant stop and start behaviour during study.

Navigation bar.

Tasks - from here the user can manage their tasks (add, remove, edit).
Graphs - from here the user can view interesting statistics and graphs based on their study habits.
Settings - from here the user can change the application settings.
Help - from here the user can view FAQs and tutorials on how to use the application.

Badges - from here the user can view the badges in which they have achieved. The reason for implementing badges comes from research on the basis of 'gamification' by Barata (2013) that states that badges can increase students' online participation, engagement and proactivity in a course in Information Systems.

View upcoming assignments.

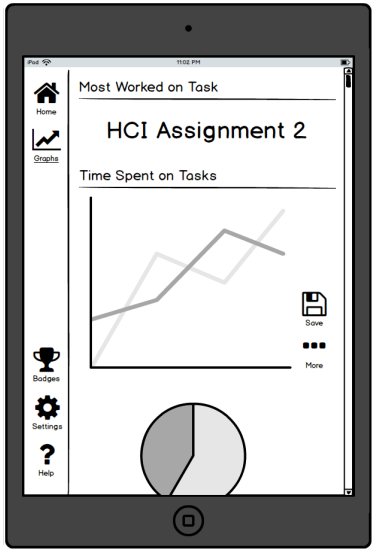
Neatly organised into an ordered table of upcoming assignments. This allows the user to see the task that is closest to its deadline and if wanted moving their attention to it.

It also shows how much time has been spent on each assignment.

Design 2- Button Based

This design shows a more detailed and different way for the user to input the amount of time they spent on a task. The user can press a button with the number of minutes on it to indicate they have spent that much time on the corresponding task. They are also able to use the timer functionality, and can add/edit/remove tasks.

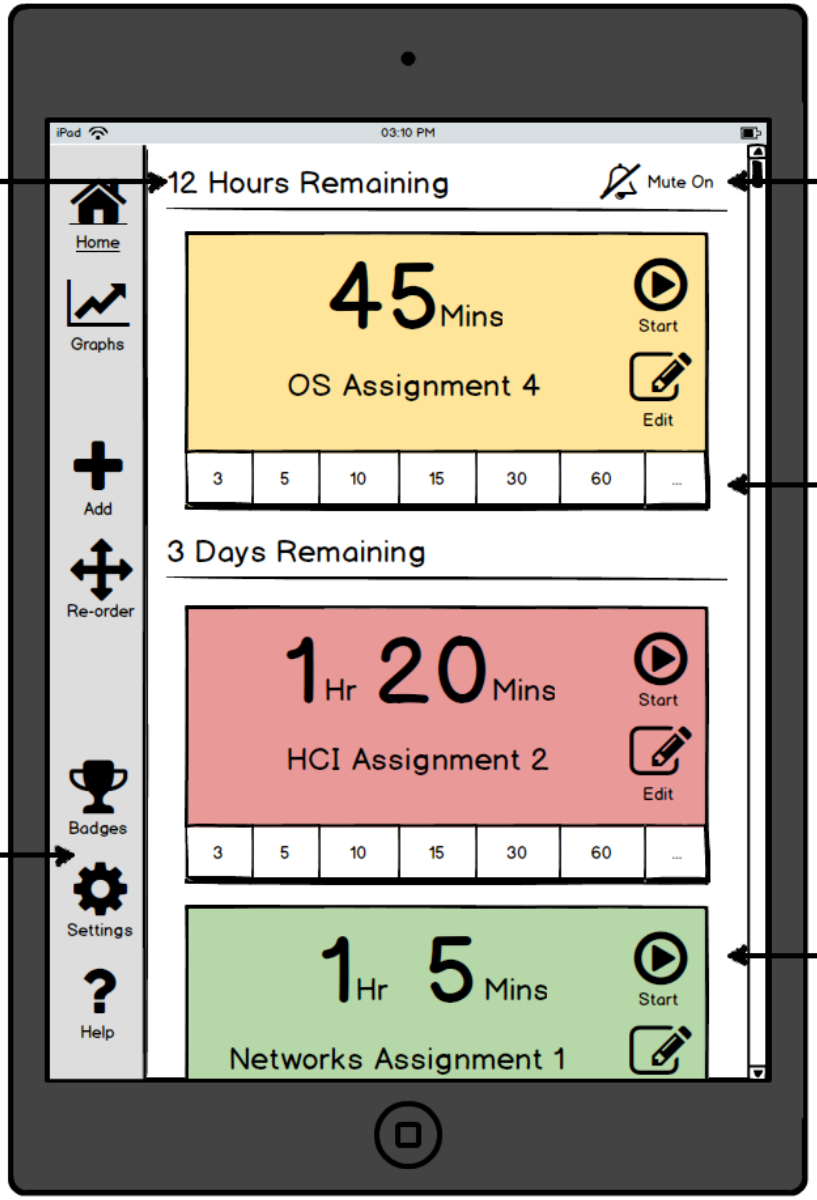
Tasks ordered by deadline.



Sample view of the graphs page.

Timed breaks.

During observation we saw that students can tend to spent hours at a time during a study session. When the user has been using the application for a long while they are informed to take a short break.



Notifications mute button.

When the user has started the timer for a particular task then the device can be configured to be placed on mute.

During observation, we saw that one problem facing students working is the disruptions from messages. Putting the device on mute after the user has indicated they are working (started the timer) helps eliminate this distraction.

In order for the user to record time spent on a task they can either, select one of the buttons to indicate (in minutes) how much time spent, or start and stop a timer.

If the user whats to record a custom amount of time spent then the ... button opens into a dropdown to supply this functionality.

The reason that the time options start at 3 minutes spent is because of research by Gonzalez annd Mark (2004) that found that "people spend on average three minutes on an event before another event is initiated".

Navigation bar.

Graphs - from here the user can view interesting statistics and graphs based on their study habits.
Add - from here the user can add a new task.
Re-order - from here the user can re-order the tasks within the indivdual deadline dates.
Settings - from here the user can change the application settings.
Help - from here the user can view FAQs and tutorials on how to use the application.

Badges - from here the user can view the badges in which they have achieved. The reason for implementing badges comes from research on the basis of 'gamification' by Barata (2013) that states that badges can increase students' online participation, engagement and proactivity in a course in Information Systems.

Easier start, pause and stop the timer.

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